

Session Note - March 12, 2026

Patient: Elena Rodriguez

Therapist: Dr. Amanda Foster, PhD

Presenting Concerns:

Patient presents with trauma-related symptoms following a motor vehicle accident eight months ago. Severity is moderate. Reports intrusive memories, hypervigilance in traffic, and avoidance of driving. These concerns are ongoing, not new this session. Triggers include loud noises and being a passenger in vehicles.

Session Summary:

In-person session focused on EMDR processing of the accident memory. Completed bilateral stimulation targeting the moment of impact. Patient demonstrated strong emotional processing with visible distress during reprocessing that resolved by end of set. SUD rating decreased from 7 to 3 during session. Patient reported feeling lighter after processing.

Mood Assessment:

Current mood: 5/10 (tense but relieved after processing)

Mood change from last session: Improved

Energy level: Normal

Emotional themes: fear, relief, cautious optimism

Affect observed: Anxious initially, shifting to calmer presentation

Affect congruence: Congruent

Mental Status Examination:

Appearance: Well-groomed

Behavior: Initially restless, became calmer during session

Speech: Normal

Thought process: Linear

Thought content: Trauma memories, safety concerns while driving

Perception: Reports occasional flashbacks of accident, no hallucinations

Cognition: Intact

Insight: Good - understands connection between trauma and current symptoms

Judgment: Good

Risk Assessment:

Suicidal ideation: None. Self-harm: None. Homicidal ideation: None. Risk level: Low.

Interventions Used:

- EMDR bilateral stimulation
- Grounding techniques
- Psychoeducation about trauma processing

Techniques were effective - SUD decreased significantly during session.

Skills taught: Container visualization for managing distressing memories between sessions

Skills practiced: Grounding techniques, safe place visualization

Homework assigned: Practice container exercise daily and note any intrusive memories in trauma log

Previous homework: Completed - practiced grounding exercises as assigned

Medications: Not applicable

Diagnoses:

Primary diagnosis: Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder

Primary diagnosis code: F43.10

Diagnosis status: No change

Treatment Progress:

Overall progress: Some improvement - SUD ratings decreasing across sessions

Treatment phase: Middle

Barriers: Avoidance of driving continues outside of sessions

Strengths: Strong engagement with EMDR process, good emotional regulation capacity

Treatment goals: Reduce intrusive symptoms, resume normal driving, decrease hypervigilance

Goals addressed: Processing traumatic memory through EMDR

Plan:

- Continue weekly sessions in person
- Next session: March 19, 2026
- Focus: Continue EMDR processing of remaining target memories
- No referrals needed at this time
- Level of care: Outpatient
- Discharge planning: Not planned